

Daily Current Affairs Digest

Current Affairs Class Notes — 25 September 2026

1. Ayushman Bharat Yojana — 8 Years Completed

Ayushman Bharat Yojana, the world's largest universal health assurance scheme, has completed **8 years** since its launch.

- Launched: 23 September 2018, from Ranchi, Jharkhand, by PM Narendra Modi.
- Run jointly under the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare and Ministry of AYUSH.
- Benefit: **■5 lakh** per family per year for secondary and tertiary care hospitalisation.
- Covers primary, secondary and tertiary care treatment (cataract surgery, minor operations, dehydration treatment, etc.) through the Ayushman Card.
- A separate card scheme now covers senior citizens above 70 years of age.
- Beneficiaries so far: around **60 crore** people.
- 23 September is observed as **Ayushman Bharat Diwas**.
- Funding split between Centre and State: 60:40 in general states; 100% Centre-funded in hilly/hill states; 90:10 (Centre:State) in North-Eastern states.
- Reports note that government spending on the scheme has exceeded its revenue allocation for it, raising fiscal deficit concerns, even as beneficiary coverage keeps expanding.

2. NDPS Act, 1985 — Intoxicating Drugs

Intoxicating drugs are regulated under the **Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act, 1985** — the only major central law on the subject (the question referenced the older United Provinces Excise Act, 1910, but current regulation is under the NDPS Act, 1985).

3. Election Commission of India & the Voter-List (SIR) Controversy

- Election Commission of India (ECI) is a **constitutional body** established under **Article 324** of the Constitution.
- It is a multi-member body: 1 Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) + 2 Election Commissioners.
- Current members discussed: CEC Gyanesh Kumar; Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi.
- As per convention/law, major decisions require consensus of all three members; in case of disagreement, voting takes place and the majority view prevails.
- An Indian Express investigation/survey found large numbers of voters missing from electoral rolls: about **47 lakh** in Bihar and about **92 lakh** in West Bengal did not figure in the voter list.
- A survey was also conducted in **Goa**, where many voters' names were found removed/declared ineligible to vote.
- The issue traced to a new column/category added in **Form 6** (the voter-registration form) called **SIR — Special Intensive Revision** (asks applicants to prove their parents'/grandparents' citizenship declaration).
- Reports allege the CEC took key decisions on this unilaterally; the other two Commissioners said they raised objections 14 times in 10 months without being heard — seen as inconsistent with the requirement of consensus among all three members.
- Opposition leaders (Rahul Gandhi, Akhilesh Yadav, and others) have raised concerns over the SIR exercise and alleged voter-list irregularities.

Quick Fact

Best description of a Fundamental Right: *"Rights protected and guaranteed by the Constitution of India."*

4. Aatmanirbhar Bharat (Self-Reliant India)

Core concept: promoting **indigenous** production and capability so India is not dependent on other countries for its needs.

5. Consolidated Fund of India

Provided for under **Article 266** of the Constitution.

6. Samudra Manthan Yojana — New Oil/Gas Reserve Found (Odisha)

- Samudra Manthan is a government initiative to explore India's own oil and gas reserves, reducing dependence on imports from the Middle East and Russia.
- Launched on **15 August 2025** (Independence Day) by PM Narendra Modi, under the **Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas**.
- Mission period: to run through **2030–31**.
- ONGC has now discovered a new reserve under this mission near the **Konark offshore** area, Odisha — about **43 km** from Konark, close to the Mahanadi river mouth.
- Depth of discovery: **1,450 metres**.
- Block name: **MDW-18** (also referred to as MD-18).
- Commercial extraction is expected to take several years (roughly 4–5 years) — not an immediate supply.

7. Mahanadi River — Quick Facts

- Origin: Chhattisgarh.
- Forms a delta at the Bay of Bengal.
- Known as the 'Lifeline of Odisha'.
- Hirakud Dam and Hirakud Reservoir are located on it.
- Cuttack city lies on its banks; Cuttack also hosts a Rice Research Centre.

8. Cyclone in the Bay of Bengal (Odisha)

A cyclone has hit Odisha (named by Bangladesh), bringing continuous heavy rainfall to the eastern coast; several schools in Odisha have been shut as a precaution.

9. Doctrine of Lapse

Introduced by Lord **Dalhousie**.

10. Heikru Hidongba Boat Race Festival — Manipur

- A traditional boat-race festival celebrated only in **Manipur** by the **Meitei** community (compare: Dal Lake boat festival in Srinagar; Vallam Kali boat race in Kerala).
- Started by King **Bhagyachandra** in **1779** — this year's edition marks **248 years**.
- Celebrated on the **11th day** of the Meitei lunar calendar (Lang Ban).
- Held at/associated with the **Bijoy Govinda Temple**.
- Notable feature: women also participate in the boat race.

11. Lok Sabha — Minimum Qualification to Contest

A person must be a **citizen of India** and **not less than 25 years** of age to contest a Lok Sabha election.

12. Death of Surya Krishnamoorthy — Founder of Soorya Festival

- Veteran figure from Kerala's film industry; also worked as an **ISRO scientist** alongside Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam.
- Founded the **Soorya Festival** (via Soorya Group/Industry, started in 1977), which finds mention in the **Limca Book of Records**.
- Received the **Kerala Prabha Award** in 2023.
- Passed away on 23 September 2026, aged 78, in Kerala.

13. Death of Veteran Actor Mushtaq Khan

Known for character/comic roles (e.g., in the film *Welcome*); passed away recently.

14. National Voters' Day

Observed every year on **25 January**.

15. UK's Military Space Squadron

- United Kingdom (England, Wales, Scotland, Northern Ireland) is setting up its own military space unit, supported by the **Royal Air Force**, under **UK Space Command**.
- The new unit is named **Number 3 Space Squadron** (Squadrons 1 and 2 already exist and issue space-event warnings).
- Context: the USA has moved weapons systems into space, and Japan earlier built a wooden satellite (LignoSat).

16. National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA)

The apex body designated for disaster management in India is the **National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA)**.

17. Father of Local Self-Government in India

Lord Ripon is known as the Father of Local Self-Government in India.

18. Sikkim's AI Fun Zone Initiative

- Sikkim has launched the '**AI Fun Zone**' initiative for students of Classes 3 to 5, using tablets, laptops, phones and computers to build digital/AI skills in English, Maths and Nepali.
- Sikkim facts: became a state via the **36th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1975**; special provisions under **Article 371F**; capital **Gangtok**; has its own separate judiciary; borders Nepal, Bhutan and China; earlier ruled long-term by the **Namgyal dynasty**.

19. NBDA — Rajat Sharma Re-elected President

- **Rajat Sharma** has been re-elected President of the **News Broadcasters & Digital Association (NBDA)** for the term **2026–2027**.
- NBDA has about 29 members and covers roughly 130 news channels — distinct from the Press Trust of India (PTI), which was established in 1947 and is headquartered in Delhi.

20. Asian Games — Medal Updates for India

- The ongoing Asian Games (20th edition) are being held in Japan.
- **Jay Meena** — Bronze medal in **Soft Tennis** (India's first-ever medal in this sport).
- **Naram Devi** — Silver medal in **Wushu**.
- **Salman Khan & Satyam Singh** — Bronze medal in **Rowing**.

21. National Lata Mangeskar Award 2026

- To be conferred on music director **Shantanu Moitra** in **Indore** on **28 September** (Lata Mangeskar's birth anniversary).
- Award instituted in **1984**, dedicated to Lata Mangeskar ('Kokila of India'); prize money: **₹5 lakh**.
- Shantanu Moitra, from Lucknow, is known for music direction in films such as *3 Idiots* and *12th Fail*; he has also previously received a national-level music award.
- Note: The separate Lata Deenanath Mangeskar Award (Maharashtra) was recently given to Kailash Satyarthi (2014 Nobel Peace Prize laureate).

Current Affairs MCQs — 25 September 2026

All multiple-choice questions covered in today's live current affairs session, with correct answers.

Q1. The Ayushman Bharat Yojana has recently completed how many years, benefiting around 60 crore people?

- (A) 6 years
- (B) 7 years
- (C) 8 years
- (D) 10 years

Answer: (C) 8 years

Q2. Intoxicating drugs are regulated under which Act in India?

- (A) United Provinces Excise Act, 1910
- (B) NDPS Act, 1985
- (C) Arms Act, 1959
- (D) Excise Act, 2001

Answer: (B) NDPS Act, 1985

Q3. In which state were voters recently found removed from the electoral rolls and declared not eligible to vote, as per the Indian Express survey?

- (A) Bihar
- (B) West Bengal
- (C) Goa
- (D) Odisha

Answer: (C) Goa

Q4. Which of the following is the best description of a Fundamental Right?

- (A) A right given by Parliament through ordinary law
- (B) A right available only to citizens above 18 years
- (C) A right protected and guaranteed by the Constitution of India
- (D) A right that can be suspended by any state government

Answer: (C) A right protected and guaranteed by the Constitution of India

Q5. The main concept of Aatmanirbhar Bharat (Self-Reliant India) is best described as:

- (A) Increasing imports
- (B) Producing goods and services indigenously
- (C) Reducing exports
- (D) Depending on foreign aid

Answer: (B) Producing goods and services indigenously

Q6. The Consolidated Fund of India is dealt with under which Article of the Constitution?

- (A) 265
- (B) 266
- (C) 267
- (D) None of the above

Answer: (B) 266

Q7. Under the Samudra Manthan Yojana, ONGC has recently found a reserve at a depth of 1450 metres near the Konark offshore area. In which state is this located?

- (A) West Bengal
- (B) Andhra Pradesh
- (C) Odisha
- (D) Tamil Nadu

Answer: (C) Odisha

Q8. The Doctrine of Lapse is associated with which Governor-General?

- (A) Lord Curzon
- (B) Lord Dalhousie
- (C) Lord Ripon
- (D) Lord Wellesley

Answer: (B) Lord Dalhousie

Q9. The Heikru Hidongba boat race festival is celebrated in which Indian state?

- (A) Kerala
- (B) Jammu & Kashmir
- (C) Manipur
- (D) Assam

Answer: (C) Manipur

Q10. What is the minimum qualification to contest a Lok Sabha election?

- (A) Citizen of India, not less than 18 years
- (B) Citizen of India, not less than 25 years
- (C) Citizen of India, not less than 30 years
- (D) Citizen of India, not less than 35 years

Answer: (B) Citizen of India, not less than 25 years

Q11. Surya Krishnamoorthy, who passed away recently, was the founder of which festival?

- (A) Sur Festival (Soorya Festival)
- (B) Kalinga Festival
- (C) Konark Festival
- (D) Hornbill Festival

Answer: (A) Sur Festival (Soorya Festival)

Q12. National Voters' Day is observed on which date every year?

- (A) 15 January
- (B) 25 January
- (C) 26 January
- (D) 1 February

Answer: (B) 25 January

Q13. Which country has recently formed a new military space squadron named 'Number 3 Space Squadron' under UK Space Command?

- (A) USA
- (B) Japan
- (C) UK
- (D) France

Answer: (C) UK

Q14. Which body is designated as the apex body for disaster management in India?

- (A) National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA)
- (B) National Disaster Response Force (NDRF)
- (C) Ministry of Home Affairs
- (D) NITI Aayog

Answer: (A) National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA)

Q15. Who is known as the 'Father of Local Self-Government' in India?

- (A) Lord Curzon
- (B) Lord Ripon
- (C) Lord Dalhousie
- (D) Lord Mountbatten

Answer: (B) Lord Ripon

Q16. Which Indian state has launched the 'AI Fun Zone' initiative for school students?

- (A) Sikkim
- (B) Assam
- (C) Manipur
- (D) Odisha

Answer: (A) Sikkim

Q17. Who has been re-elected President of the News Broadcasters & Digital Association (NBDA) for 2026–2027?

- (A) Arnab Goswami
- (B) Rajat Sharma
- (C) Prannoy Roy
- (D) Rajdeep Sardesai

Answer: (B) Rajat Sharma

Q18. The National Lata Mangeskar Award 2026 will be conferred on which music director?

- (A) A.R. Rahman
- (B) Pritam
- (C) Shantanu Moitra
- (D) Shankar Mahadevan

Answer: (C) Shantanu Moitra

Q19. In the ongoing Asian Games, Jay Meena won India's first-ever medal in which sport?

- (A) Wushu
- (B) Rowing
- (C) Soft Tennis
- (D) Sepak Takraw

Answer: (C) Soft Tennis

Q20. Naram Devi won a Silver medal for India in which sport at the Asian Games?

- (A) Wushu
- (B) Judo
- (C) Karate
- (D) Taekwondo

Answer: (A) Wushu